

11 most in-demand soft skills in 2025



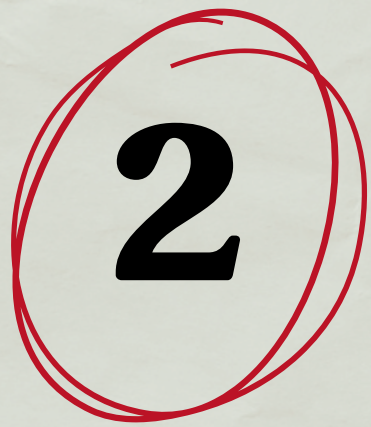


Adaptability

- 77% of business and HR leaders want you to be able to move skills between roles. (Deloitte)
- Companies want people who can quickly respond to changes, go with the flow, and thrive in cross-functional situations.



Work on creative problem solving & find new ways to put yourself in unfamiliar settings.



Analytical thinking

- Companies want people that can analyze problems cross-functionally with other stakeholders and avoid silos.



- This includes data interpretation, critical thinking, problem solving, and data modeling.



Do brain puzzles daily and volunteer for cross-functional projects on your team.

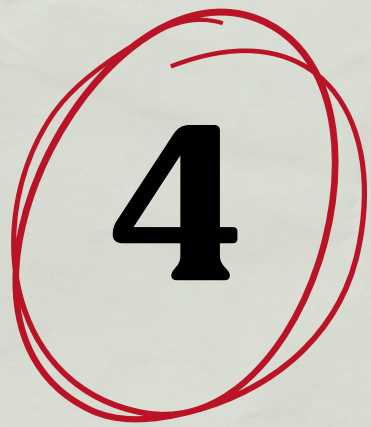


Management skills

- Companies want to know how well you can organize & influence other stakeholders.
- Bad managers are the #1 reason people quit jobs and companies lose money in disengagement and bad productivity.



Improve your decision making, communication, & organizational skills.



Creative thinking

- Creative thinking will grow faster than analytical thinking for the next 5 years.
- Employers want creative problem solvers, but also people who are open-minded and open to testing new and unconventional ideas.



Practice collaborating and “thinking with” AI tools in prep for mass adoption.

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Communication skills

- Communication is the heart of effective collaboration & mitigating work conflicts.
- Expect to see more testing for written, verbal, active listening, & asynchronous communication skills in the hiring process.



Work on your concision, email etiquette, and listening to understand.

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Emotional intelligence

- Employers want people who can manage their emotional responses & be aware of their effect on others.



- Emotional intelligence is a top driver of better company cultures and helps with team cohesion.



Practice empathy, self-awareness, and emotional self-regulation.



Leadership skills

- Companies want everyone to take a leadership role within projects & initiatives.
- They're looking for people with integrity, good communication skills, gratitude, and influence.



Find ways to lead in your current role, such as helping to train a new hire or manage a project.



Life-long learning

- We'll be in “the great upskilling” as mass AI adoption happens at an enterprise level.
- Employers want to retain top talent but give them new skills or move them to different functions.



Get ahead and look at the most in demand skills by 2030 to start self-learning.



Taking ownership

- In the hybrid & remote world, companies want people who are able to work autonomously & successfully deliver outcomes.
- Team structures are changing (getting smaller, more flat, etc.) so everyone needs to step up.



Always deliver on time or communicate early if you're going to have a delay.

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Sales skills

- Every single person needs to be able to persuade people to see things from their perspective.
- This will also help you be better at interviews, advocating for yourself in promotions, leading initiatives, etc.



Practice “selling” everyday objects in your life—your pens, your toaster, your car, etc.

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Teamwork/ Collaboration

- Better teamwork makes for faster outcomes & time and money saved.
- Demand for teamwork skills went up by nearly 50% in 2024 (Forbes)



**Find ways to work together
with your family & friends to
achieve goals.**

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